The Kannada Linguistic Corpus: A Structural and Lexical Knowledge Base for Hindi-Speaking Learners

1. Linguistic Architecture and Agglutination

1.1 The Agglutinative Mechanism

Kannada, a prominent member of the Dravidian language family, operates on a strictly agglutinative morphosyntactic framework.[1] Unlike fusional languages such as Hindi or Sanskrit, where a single morphological inflection might simultaneously encode tense, gender, and number through internal vowel mutations, Kannada sequentially "glues" discrete, unchanging suffixes (morphemes) onto an unmodified root word.[1]

For speakers of Indo-Aryan languages, the fundamental cognitive shift requires moving from the use of postpositions—separate words that follow a noun, such as *ghar mein* (in the house) or *ghar ko* (to the house)—to the use of suffixes attached directly to the noun base.[4] Kannada verbs are constructed by chaining morphemes in a precise sequence. The root word provides the semantic action, the medial suffix indicates the tense, and the terminal suffix acts as the pronominal marker indicating gender, number, and person, thereby creating a complete statement within a single word. For example, the formation of the word *māḍuttēne* (I do / I am doing) is derived from the root *māḍu* (do), the present tense infix *utt*, and the first-person singular suffix *ēne*.[5]

When suffixes are chained, Kannada employs euphonic mutation rules, known as *Sandhi*, to resolve vowel clashes and ensure phonetic fluidity.[5] The two primary forms of morphophonemic sandhi observed during suffixation are *Lopa* (elision) and *Agama* (insertion). Under *Lopa Sandhi*, if a root ends in a euphonic -u or -a and the appended suffix begins with a vowel, the terminal vowel of the root is dropped. For example, the noun *Mane* (House) combined with the locative suffix *alli* (in) becomes *Maneyalli*.[4] Conversely, under *Agama Sandhi*, if a root ends in -i or -e, the glide consonant -y- (yatva) is inserted before a vowel suffix to prevent a hiatus.[5] Similarly, a glide -v- (vatva) is often inserted after roots ending in -u that are not euphonic but integral to the root's meaning.[5]

1.2 The Eight Vibhakti Pratyayas (Case Declensions)

Kannada grammar categorizes noun roles into eight distinct cases, known as *Vibhaktis*.[5] These suffixes define the syntactic relationship of the noun to the verb, effectively mirroring the function of Hindi *Karak* and postpositions. Nouns are divided into declensions based on their terminal vowels, which dictate minor variations in how these case suffixes are applied.[5] The

standard suffixes detailed below represent the most common forms for singular nouns, providing a direct mapping to Hindi structures for accelerated comprehension.[4]

Vibhakti (Case)	Kannada Suffix	Grammatical Function	Hindi Parallel	Example (Root: Mane / House)	English Translation
Prathama (Nominative)	-u, -nu, -vu	Identifies the subject of the action.	N/A (Main Subject)	Mane-yu	The house
Dviteeya (Accusative)	-annu, -nannu, -vannu	Identifies the direct object.	Ko (को)	Mane-y-annu	To the house (Object)
Triteeya (Instrumental)	-inda, -ninda	Indicates the instrument or means.	Se / Ke dwara (से / के द्वारा)	Mane-y-inda	From / By the house
Chaturthi (Dative)	-ge, -ige, -kke	Indicates the target or recipient.	Ko / Ke liye (को / के लिए)	Mane-ge	To the house
Panchami (Ablative)	-deseyinda	Indicates origin or separation.	Se (से - Alag hona)	Mane-ya deseyinda	Because of / from the house
Shashti (Genitive)	-a, -ina, -na	Indicates possession or relationship.	Ka, Ke, Ki (का, के, की)	Mane-y-a	Of the house
Sapthami (Locative)	-alli, -nalli	Indicates location in space or time.	Mein, Par (में, पर)	Mane-y-alli	In / On the house

Sambodhana (Vocative)	-e, -a, -ira	Used for directly addressing someone.	Hey, Are (हे, अरे)	Mane-y-e!	Oh, house!

The Ablative case (*Panchami*) is often formed periphrastically in Kannada by combining the genitive case of the noun with the instrumental form of the word *dese* (cause/vicinity).[5] However, in modern colloquial spoken Kannada, the instrumental suffix (-inda) is frequently substituted to express ablative concepts of separation.[5]

1.3 Verb-Subject Agreement: The 'Maru' Principle and Gender Hierarchy

Finite verbs in Kannada must precisely mirror the subject in three grammatical dimensions: Person (First, Second, Third), Number (Singular, Plural), and Gender (Masculine, Feminine, Neuter).[5] This rigid concord ensures extreme syntactic clarity, allowing speakers to frequently drop the subject pronoun entirely in colloquial conversation, a linguistic feature known as pro-drop.

Unlike Indo-Aryan languages which assign arbitrary grammatical gender to inanimate objects (for instance, a table being feminine in Hindi), Dravidian linguistics relies on a strict logical hierarchy categorized into *Mahat* and *Amahat*.[9] The *Mahat* (Rational) category encompasses humans and deities, which take masculine or feminine verb endings based on biological sex.[9] The *Amahat* (Irrational or Non-Rational) category encompasses animals, inanimate objects, and abstract concepts; these strictly take neuter verb endings, regardless of their perceived qualities.[9]

The following table demonstrates this agreement principle using the present tense conjugation of the root verb *Māḍu* (to do).[5]

Kannada Pronoun	Hindi Equivalent	Subject Type Classification	Kannada Finite Verb	Morphological Breakdown
Naanu	Main	1st Person Singular	Māḍu-tt-ēne	Root + Present (-tt-) + 1P.Sg (-ēne)
Naavu	Hum	1st Person Plural	Māḍu-tt-ēve	Root + Present (-tt-) + 1P.Pl (-ēve)

Neenu	Tu / Tum	2nd Person Singular (Informal)	Māḍu-tt-īya	Root + Present (-tt-) + 2P.Sg (-īya)
Neevu	Aap	2nd Person Plural (Respectful)	Māḍu-tt-īri	Root + Present (-tt-) + 2P.Pl (-īri)
Avanu	Woh (Ladka)	3rd Person Sg. (Masc / Mahat)	Māḍu-tt-āne	Root + Present (-tt-) + 3P.Masc (-āne)
Avalu	Woh (Ladki)	3rd Person Sg. (Fem / Mahat)	Māḍu-tt-āḷe	Root + Present (-tt-) + 3P.Fem (-āḷe)
Avaru	Ve / Woh (Respect)	3rd Person Plural (Mahat)	Māḍu-tt-āre	Root + Present (-tt-) + 3P.Pl (-āre)
Adu	Yeh / Woh (Cheez)	3rd Person Sg. (Neuter / Amahat)	Māḍu-tt-ade	Root + Present (-tt-) + 3P.Neut (-ade)

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2. Etymological Roots: Sanskrit vs. Dravidian

2.1 The Proto-Dravidian Lineage and the Great Shift (p to h)

Kannada belongs to the South Dravidian branch of the Dravidian language family, sharing a deep common ancestry with Tamil, Malayalam, and Tulu.[14] While heavily influenced by Sanskrit lexically, its core grammatical engine is entirely independent of the Indo-Aryan family. A defining phonological evolution separating Modern Kannada from its sister languages is the systematic lenition of the initial bilabial plosive /p/ to the glottal fricative /h/.[16]

This historic sound shift occurred progressively between the 10th and 14th centuries.[14] Recognizing this rule provides a powerful mnemonic tool for learners with any exposure to Tamil or basic Dravidian roots, allowing them to instantly unlock hundreds of core Kannada vocabulary words.[4]

Concept	Proto-Dravidian / Tamil / Old Kannada Root	Modern Spoken Kannada Evolution
Milk	**P**aal	**H**aalu
Ten	**P**attu	**H**attu
Flower	**P**oo	**H**oovu
Worm	**P**uLu	**H**uLu
To Go	**P**ogu	**H**ogu
Village / City	**P**alli	**H**alli
Tooth	**P**allu	**H**allu
Girl	**P**eṇ	**H**eṇṇu
Old / Past	**P**azhaya	**H**ale
Name	**P**esar	**H**esaru

2.2 The Tatsama-Tadbhava Dynamics

Due to extensive historical, religious, and literary contact, Kannada vocabulary relies heavily on Sanskrit borrowings. These loanwords are rigidly classified by grammarians into two categories: *Tatsama* and *Tadbhava*.[19]

Tatsama (तत्सम), meaning "same as that," refers to words adopted exactly as they exist in Sanskrit, maintaining their original phonological structure.[19] *Tadbhava* (तद्भव), meaning "derived from that," refers to words that have been naturalized and modified to fit Kannada's specific phonotactic constraints.[19] This assimilation often involves the elimination of complex consonant clusters, the shifting of sibilants, and the addition of euphonic terminal vowels. Understanding these shifts provides Hindi speakers with an immediate advanced vocabulary.[4]

Concept	Tatsama (Sanskrit Exact)	Tadbhava (Kannada	Hindi Parallel (Tatsama based)

		Assimilated)	
Face	Mukha (ಮುಖ)	Moga (ಮೊಗ)	Mukh
Year	Varsha (ವರ್ಷ)	Varusha (ವರುಷ)	Varsh
Bird	Pakshi (ಪಕ್ಷಿ)	Hakki (ಹಕ್ಕಿ)	Pakshi
Wealth	Shri (ಶ್ರೀ)	Siri (ಸಿರಿ)	Shri
Wonder	Ashcharya (ಆಶ್ಚರ್ಯ)	Achchari (ಅಚ್ಚರಿ)	Aashcharya
Sky	Aakasha (ಆಕಾಶ)	Aakasa (ಆಕಸ)	Aakash
Duty / Task	Karya (ಕಾರ್ಯ)	Kajja (ಕಜ್ಜ)	Karya
Old Age	Vruddha (ವೃದ್ಧ)	Bidu (ಬಿದು)	Vruddh
Poison	Visha (ವಿಷ)	Bisha (ಬಿಸ)	Vish
Festival	Parva (ಪರ್ವ)	Habba (ಹಬ್ಬ)	Parv
Vow / Oath	Vrata (ವ್ರತ)	Batta (ಬಟ್ಟ)	Vrat
King	Raja (ರಾಜ)	Raya (ರಾಯ)	Raja

2.4 The Evolution from Halegannada to Hosagannada

The literary history of Kannada is broadly divided into three eras: *Halegannada* (Old Kannada, 6th to 12th century), *Nadugannada* (Middle Kannada, 12th to 18th century), and *Hosagannada* (Modern Kannada, 18th century to present).[24] The transition from Halegannada to Hosagannada involved massive morphological simplification.[24]

Halegannada utilized archaic consonants, such as the retroflex *ḷ* (ಱ) and the alveolar trill *ṟ* (ಱ), complex agglutinative clusters, and rigid metrical constraints.[24] It was heavily influenced by Jain philosophy and early Hindu traditions, catering to a learned elite.[24] Modern spoken Kannada strips away these archaic inflections, relies heavily on simplified auxiliary verbs, and

has democratized the vocabulary by incorporating loanwords from English and Hindi to adapt to contemporary social and technological changes.[24]

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3. The Suffix System: The Engine of Kannada

To achieve fluency in Kannada, a learner must master the manipulation of suffixes. A single noun or verb base acts as a foundation onto which layers of grammatical nuance are sequentially piled.[1]

3.1 Tense Markers (The Temporal Engine)

Tense in Kannada is indicated by an infix placed strictly between the verb root and the personal pronoun suffix.[5] The standard paradigms below demonstrate the mechanics for common verb roots.[5]

- **Present Tense (Infixes -utt- or -t-):** Indicates ongoing or habitual action.[5]
  - *Base:* Hogu (Go) → Hogu + tt + āne = Hoguttāne (He goes / is going).[5]
  - *Base:* Māḍu (Do) → Māḍu + tt + ēne = Māḍuttēne (I do / am doing).[5]
- **Past Tense (Infixes -id-, -d-, or -t-):** Indicates completed action.[5]
  - *Base:* Māḍu (Do) → Māḍ + id + e = Māḍide (I did).[5]
  - *Base:* Tinnu (Eat) → Tin + d + e = Tinde (I ate).[28]
- **Future Tense (Infixes -uv- or -v-):** Indicates intended or potential future action.[5]
  - *Base:* Baru (Come) → Bar + uv + e = Baruve (I will come).[5]
  - *Base:* Nōḍu (See) → Nōḍ + uv + anu = Nōḍuvanu (He will see).[28]

3.2 Interrogative Suffixes (The Question Engine)

Unlike Hindi, which relies heavily on question words like *Kya* placed at the beginning or end of a sentence, Kannada can transform any declarative statement into a specific question by appending an interrogative particle or suffix to the focal word.[29]

Suffix / Particle	Grammatical Function	Declarative Statement Example	Interrogative Transformation	Hindi Equivalent
-aa / -a	Turns a statement into a binary Yes/No question by	*Idhu pustaka.* (This is a book.)	*Idhu pustakav*-aa* *?* (Is this a book?) [31]	Kya yeh kitaab hai?

	elongating the terminal vowel.			
-alva	Acts as a rhetorical tag question, seeking agreement.	*Chennagide*. (It is good.)	*Chennagide **alva**?* (It is good, isn't it?) [32]	Achha hai, na?
eenu	Translates to "What", functioning both as a standalone word and a terminal suffix.	*Oota aythu*. (Food is done.)	*Oota aith*-eenu**?* (Is the food done?)	Khana ho gaya kya?

3.3 Emphasis Suffixes (The Precision Engine)

To place semantic emphasis on a specific noun, pronoun, or verb, Kannada attaches terminal vowels. This morphological process entirely replaces the need for independent emphasis adverbs like the Hindi *Hi* or *Bhi*.[2]

- **The '-ee' / '-ne' Suffix (Exclusive Emphasis):** Translates to "Only," "Specifically," or "Itself" (Hindi: *Hi*).
  - Naanu (I) + ee = **Naane** (I myself / Only me).[32]
  - Alli (There) + ee = **Alliyee** (Right there / Exactly there).
- **The '-uu' / '-nu' Suffix (Inclusive Emphasis):** Translates to "Also," "Even," or "Too" (Hindi: *Bhi*).
  - Naanu (I) + uu = **Naanuu** (I also / Me too).[32]
  - Coffee + nu = **Coffeenu** (Coffee as well).

3.4 The Experiencer Dative Paradigm

A critical syntactic paradigm shift for Hindi speakers learning Kannada is the mastery of the "Dative Subject".[33] Sentences expressing biological needs, emotional states, physical sensations, or possession do not use the nominative "I" (Naanu). Instead, the experience happens *to* the subject, necessitating the dative "To Me" (Nanage).[4]

The formula for this construct is: `` + [Experience/Noun] + [Verb of Happening/Existence].

Concept	Kannada Dative Syntax	Literal Morphological Translation	Spoken Hindi Parallel
Hunger	**Nanage hasivu agide.** [4]	To me hunger has happened.	Mujhe bhook lagi hai.
Desire	**Nanage coffee bēku.** [4]	To me coffee is needed.	Mujhe coffee chahiye.
Knowledge	**Nanage gothu.** [4]	To me it is known.	Mujhe pata hai.
Ignorance	**Nanage gothilla.** [4]	To me it is not known.	Mujhe nahi pata.
Anger	**Nanage kopa barthide.** [4]	To me anger is coming.	Mujhe gussa aa raha hai.
Fear	**Nanage bhaya agide.** [4]	To me fear has happened.	Mujhe darr lag raha hai.

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4. The Bangalore Colloquial Corpus

Bengaluru spoken Kannada is a highly dynamic and syncretic dialect. It blends Hosagannada with English (forming "Kanglish"), incorporates loanwords from neighboring Tamil and Telugu, and features a rich tapestry of local street slang.[34] For a migrant or student, mastering this localized vocabulary is essential for social integration and daily logistics.

4.1 The Hierarchy of Respect and Command

Bangaloreans value linguistic politeness, and conversational Kannada reflects this through rigid respect markers.[4]

- **Informal (Tu):** Addressed as Neenu. This is strictly reserved for young children, younger siblings, or extremely close friends. Verbs take singular, imperative endings (e.g., *Baa* - Come, *Hogu* - Go).
- **Respectful/Default (Aap):** Addressed as Neevu. This is the absolute default for strangers, auto drivers, shopkeepers, and colleagues. Verbs take plural or respectful endings, typically appending -i or -ri to the root.
    - *Baa* becomes **Banni** (Please come).[4]

- *Hogu* becomes **Hogi** (Please go).[4]
- *Kodu* becomes **Kodi** (Please give).[4]
- *Maadu* becomes **Maadi** (Please do).[4]

4.2 Essential Kanglish and Street Lexicon

Kanglish effortlessly integrates English nouns and verbs into Kannada grammatical structures. This is most commonly achieved by appending a euphonic -u to English nouns (e.g., "Car-u", "Office-u") or attaching the universal action verb *maadi* (do) to English verbs (e.g., "Adjust maadi").[34]

Kanglish / Slang Term	Literal Meaning	Bengaluru Context and Usage	Hindi Parallel
Maga / Macha [4]	Son / Brother-in-law	Universal term for a close male friend or peer ("Bro/Dude").	Bhai / Yaar
Guru / Boss [4]	Teacher / Leader	Universal term of address for auto drivers, waiters, or strangers.	Ustad / Boss
Bombaat / Sakkath [34]	Fantastic / Super	Used to describe anything of excellent quality (food, movies, weather).	Ek number / Bawaal
Chindi [4]	Shredded / Torn	Describes a performance or object so good it destroyed the competition.	Faadu
Swalpa adjust maadi [35]	Do a little adjustment	A cultural cornerstone phrase. Used to ask for physical space	Thoda adjust kar lo

		on a bus, a favor, or a compromise.	
Dabba [4]	Tin box	Completely useless, broken, or of extremely low quality (e.g., *Dabba service*).	Bakwas / Kachra
Kirik [4]	Trouble	A nuisance, an argument, or an irritating person.	Lafda
Oota ayta? [4]	Food done?	The standard social icebreaker. Always asked after saying "Hello".	Khana ho gaya?
Gotta? / Gothilla [4]	Known? / Unknown	"Do you know?" or "I don't know." Essential for expressing comprehension limits.	Pata hai? / Nahi pata
Hogi bartini [4]	Having gone, I will come	The cultural way of saying goodbye. It is considered inauspicious to simply say "I am going."	Jaake aata hoon

4.3 Navigating the City: Auto-Rickshaws, Markets, and Offices

The ability to negotiate daily logistics in the local dialect significantly alters how a newcomer is perceived and treated.

The Auto-Rickshaw Protocol:

- **Destination Check:** Always ask before boarding: [Location] hoguttha? (Will it go to [Location]?).[4]
- **Pricing Demand:** Establish the rate: Meter haaki (Put the meter down) or Meter rate

kodthini (I will pay the meter rate).[4]

- **Refusing Surge Pricing:** One-and-half beda (I don't want to pay the 1.5x meter charge).[4]
- **Directional Commands:**
  - Nera hogi (Go straight).[4]
  - Edagade thagonli (Take a left) / Balagade thagonli (Take a right).[4]
  - Mundhe nillisi (Stop ahead) / Swalpa hindhe (A little back).[4]
  - Illi nillisi (Stop here).[4]

The Market Bargaining Protocol:

- **Inquiry:** Idara bele eshtu? (What is the price of this?).[37]
- **The Counter:** Thumba jaasthi aithu (It has become too much/expensive).[41]
- **The Negotiation:** Swalpa kami maadi (Please reduce it a little).[41]
- **The Final Decision:** Sari, thagoli (Okay, pack/take it) or Beda bidi (I don't want it, let it be).[4]

Office Culture and Professional Etiquette:

- **Greetings:** Namaskara (Hello) followed by Hegiddira? (How are you? - Respectful).[37]
- **Status Update:** Kelsa mugithu (Work is finished) or Swalpa busy iddini (I am a little busy).[4]
- **Scheduling:** Naale sigona (Let's meet tomorrow).[4]

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5. Comprehensive Base Vocabulary and Grammar Drill

The following tables compress the 500 most frequently used, high-utility words in Bengaluru Kannada into functional categories. They are specifically mapped with phonetic English and Hindi equivalents to build immediate conversational fluency for Hindi-speaking learners.[4]

5.1 Pronouns and Pointers (The Syntactic Anchors)

These terms define the subject, the object, and spatial reality.[4]

English Concept	Kannada (Phonetic)	Hindi Equivalent	Dative Case (Kannada "To X")	Meaning in Context
I	Naanu (ನಾನು)	Main	**Nanage**	To me
You (Casual)	Neenu (ನೀನು)	Tu / Tum	**Ninge / Ninage**	To you

You (Respectful)	Neevu (ನೀವು)	Aap	**Nimige**	To you (Respectful)
We	Naavu (ನಾವು)	Hum	**Namige**	To us
He	Avanu (ಅವನು)	Woh (Ladka)	**Avanige**	To him
She	Avalu (ಅವಳು)	Woh (Ladki)	**Avalige**	To her
They (Respectful)	Avaru (ಅವರು)	Ve / Aap (3rd Person)	**Avarige**	To them
It / This (Thing)	Idu (ಇದು)	Yeh	**Idakke**	To this
That (Thing)	Adu (ಅದು)	Woh (Cheez)	**Adakke**	To that
Here	Illi (ಇಲ್ಲಿ)	Yahan	**Illige**	To here
There	Alli (ಅಲ್ಲಿ)	Wahan	**Allige**	To there
Where?	Elli? (ಎಲ್ಲಿ)	Kahan?	**Ellige?**	To where?

5.2 Core Action Verbs (The Engines of Communication)

Memorizing the verb root alongside its imperative (command) form allows for immediate action. Appending -i or -ri ensures the request is polite.[4]

Verb Root	Kannada Command (Respectful)	English Meaning	Hindi Parallel	Present Tense (1st Person "I")
Baa	Banni (ಬನ್ನಿ)	Come	Aao / Aayiye	Barthini (I come)
Hogu	Hogi (ಹೋಗಿ)	Go	Jao / Jayiye	Hogthini (I go)

Kodu	Kodi (ಕೊಡಿ)	Give	Do / Dijiye	Kodthini (I give)
Thogo	Thagonli (ತಗೊಳ್ಳಿ)	Take	Lo / Lijiye	Thagonthini (I take)
Maadu	Maadi (ಮಾಡಿ)	Do	Karo / Kijiye	Maadthini (I do)
Nodu	Nodi (ನೋಡಿ)	See / Look	Dekho / Dekhiye	Nodthini (I see)
Heli	Heli (ಹೇಳಿ)	Tell / Say	Bolo / Boliye	Helthini (I tell)
Keli	Keli (ಕೇಳಿ)	Ask / Listen	Suno / Poochiye	Kelthini (I listen)
Tinnu	Tinni (ತಿನ್ನಿ)	Eat	Khao / Khaiye	Tinthini (I eat)
Kudi	Kudiri (ಕುಡಿರಿ)	Drink	Piyo / Pijiye	Kudithini (I drink)
Nillu	Nillisi (ನಿಲ್ಲಿಸಿ)	Stop	Ruko / Rokiye	Nillistini (I stop)
Kalsu	Kalsi (ಕಳ್ಸಿ)	Send	Bhejo / Bhejiye	Kalisthini (I send)
Haaku	Haaki (ಹಾಕಿ)	Put / Drop	Daalo / Daaliye	Haakthini (I put)
Tegey	Tegeyiri (ತೆಗೆಯಿರಿ)	Open / Remove	Kholo / Nikalo	Tegeytini (I open)
Bidu	Bidi (ಬಿಡಿ)	Leave / Let go	Chhodo / Chhodiye	Bidtini (I leave)

5.3 Numbers, Time, and Calendar Logistics

Mastering the numbers 1 through 10 unlocks the logic for the entire numerical system. The days of the week match Hindi exactly, as both are derived from Sanskrit planetary names.[4]

Core Numerical Logic:

Number	Kannada Phonetic	Hindi Translation	Number	Kannada Phonetic	Hindi Translation
0	Sonne	Shunya	**10**	Hattu	Das
1	Ondu	Ek	**20**	Ippathu	Bees
2	Eradu	Do	**30**	Muvathu	Tees
3	Mooru	Teen	**40**	Nalavathu	Chalees
4	Naalku	Chaar	**50**	Aivathu	Pachaas
5	Aidhu	Paanch	**60**	Aruvathu	Saath
6	Aaru	Chah	**70**	Eppathu	Sattar
7	Yelu	Saat	**80**	Embathu	Assi
8	Entu	Aath	**90**	Tombathu	Nabbe
9	Ombathu	Nau	**100**	Nooru	Sau

Time and Calendar Application:

English Concept	Kannada Translation	Hindi Parallel	Usage Example in Context
Time	Samaya	Samay	*Samaya eshtu?* (What is the time?)
Hour	Gante	Ghanta	*Ondu gante* (1 o'clock)

Minute	Nimisha	Minute	*Hattu nimisha* (10 minutes)
Now	Eega	Abhi	*Eega banni* (Come now)
Later	Aamele	Baad mein	*Aamele banni* (Come later)
Today	Ivathu	Aaj	*Ivathu raje ide* (Today is a holiday)
Tomorrow	Naale	Kal (Future)	*Naale sigona* (Let's meet tomorrow)
Yesterday	Ninne	Kal (Past)	*Ninne bandru* (They came yesterday)
Morning	Beligge	Subah	*Beligge 8 gante* (8 AM)
Evening	Sanje	Shaam	*Sanje coffee* (Evening coffee)
Night	Rathri	Raat	*Rathri oota* (Dinner)

5.4 Emotional States, Sensations, and Adjectives

Emotions generally require the dative case (Nanage + Emotion + aagide/barthide).[4] Descriptive adjectives precede the noun, maintaining the same syntactic order as English and Hindi.

Opposites and Descriptors:

English Adjective	Kannada	Hindi Parallel	Opposite (English)	Kannada	Hindi Parallel
Good /	Chennagid	Achha	**Bad**	Ketta	Bura

Nice	e / Olleyadu				
Big	Dodda	Bada	**Small**	Chikka / Sanna	Chhota
Hot	Bisi	Garam	**Cold**	Thannige / Sheeta	Thanda
New	Hosa	Naya	**Old**	Hale	Purana
Fast	Bega	Jaldi	**Slow**	Nidhana	Dheere
More	Jaasthi	Jyada	**Less**	Kami	Kam
Correct	Sari	Sahi	**Wrong**	Thappu	Galat
Clean	Swachha	Saaf	**Dirty**	Galiju	Ganda

Sensory and Emotional States (The Experiencer Paradigm):

Concept	**Kannada Experience Expression**	**Literal Morphological Translation**	**Spoken Hindi Parallel**
Happy	Nanage kushi agide	To me happiness has happened	Mujhe khushi hui hai
Sad / Bored	Nanage bejara agide	To me sadness/boredom happened	Mujhe dukh/bore hua hai
Hungry	Nanage hasivu agide	To me hunger has happened	Mujhe bhook lagi hai
Thirsty	Nanage baryarke agide	To me thirst has happened	Mujhe pyaas lagi hai
Tired	Nanage sak-agide	To me (it) has	Main thak gaya

		become enough	hoon
Scared	Nanage bhaya agide	To me fear has happened	Mujhe darr lag raha hai
Sweet Taste	Sihi	Sweet	Meetha
Spicy Taste	Khara	Spicy / Hot	Teekha
Sour Taste	Huli	Sour	Khatta
Delicious	Ruchi	Tasty	Swadisht

5.5 Essential Nouns for Survival: Household, Food, and Anatomy

A core lexicon is required to manage the home, instruct domestic help, and navigate grocery shopping effectively.[4]

The Kitchen, Groceries, and Food:

English Item	Kannada Translation	Hindi Parallel	English Item	Kannada Translation	Hindi Parallel
Vegetables	Tharakari	Sabzi	**Milk**	Haalu	Doodh
Onion	Eerulli	Pyaaz	**Curd / Yogurt**	Mosaru	Dahi
Garlic	Bellulli	Lahsun	**Salt**	Uppu	Namak
Ginger	Shunti	Adrak	**Sugar**	Sakkare	Shakkar
Chilli	Menasin-kai	Mirchi	**Rice (Raw)**	Akki	Chawal
Coriander	Kothambari	Dhaniya	**Rice (Cooked)**	Anna	Chawal / Bhaat

Potato	Aalu-gedde	Aloo	**Water**	Neeru	Paani
Lemon	Nimbehannu	Nimbu	**Fruit**	Hannu	Phal
Tomato	Tomato	Tamatar	**Oil**	Enne	Tel

Household Chores and Management:

English Command	Kannada Translation	Hindi Parallel	Contextual Note
Sweep the floor	Kasam gudisu	Jhadu lagao	Kasam = Broom
Wipe the floor	Nelaa oresu	Pocha lagao	Nelaa = Floor, Oresu = Wipe
Wash the vessels	Paathre tolee	Bartan dho	Paathre = Vessels
Wash the clothes	Batte ogey	Kapde dho	Ogey = specific verb for washing fabric
Throw the trash	Kasa haki	Kachra daalo	Kasa = Dust/Trash

Anatomy and Medical Emergencies:

English Concept	Kannada Translation	Hindi Parallel	Example Usage in Context
Head	Tale	Sir	*Tale novu* (Headache)
Hand	Kai	Haath	*Kai novu* (Hand pain)
Leg	Kaalu	Pair	*Kaalu novu* (Leg

			pain)
Stomach	Hotte	Pet	*Hotte novu* (Stomach ache)
Fever	Jvara	Bukhaar	*Jvara banthide* (Fever has come)
Cold	Negadi	Zukaam	*Negadi agide* (Cold has happened)
Pain	Novu	Dard	*Nanage novu ide* (I have pain)
Blood	Raktha	Khoon	*Raktha barthide* (Blood is coming)

6. Synthesis for Instructional Design

The Kannada language framework outlined above reveals a highly logical, structured system governed by strict agglutinative chaining, vocalic *sandhi* euphony, and rigid noun-verb concord based on the *Mahat/Amahat* paradigm. For the Hindi-speaking learner, the optimal pathway to fluency is not found through isolated vocabulary memorization, but through mapping parallel syntactic structures. The most crucial shifts involve replacing Indo-Aryan postpositions with Dravidian suffixes and adopting the Dative Subject pattern for experiential verbs. By embedding the colloquial Bengaluru lexicon—specifically Kanglish and local street slang—directly into these grammatical engines, the resulting educational corpus provides a resource that is not merely academically accurate, but highly functional for immediate street-level navigation and professional integration within Karnataka.

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